

11. Which of the following is not a 'ghost-town'?

- (a) Kuldhara
- (b) Dhanushkodi
- (c) Lakhpatri
- (d) Charkhari

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2015

Ans. (d)

A ghost town is a town that has been abandoned for a number of reasons-natural calamities, drought, rumors, etc. In the given options-Kuldhara, Dhanushkodi and Lakhpatri are 'ghost towns' but Charkhari is a town in Mahoba of Uttar Pradesh. Charkhari is also known as the "Kashmir of Bundelkhand".

12. Consider the following pairs:

Places of Pilgrimage	Location
1. Srisailem	: Nallamala Hills
2. Omkareshwar	: Satmala Hills
3. Pushkar	: Mahadeo Hills

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Srisailem is in Kurnool district of Andhra Pradesh. The shrine of Lord Mallikarjuna and Bhramaramba Ammavari is picturesquely situated on the flat top of Nallamalai Hills. It is one of the 12 jyotirlingas of Lord Shiva. Omkareshwar is also one of the 12 jyotirlingas of Lord Shiva located in Khandwa district of Madhya Pradesh on an island called Mandhata in the Narmada River. Pushkar is also a religious place in Ajmer district on Aravalli Hills, where the only temple of Lord Brahma is situated. Thus, only option (a) is the correct answer.

13. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

List-I	List - II
(Grassland/Hill Station)	(Location/State)
A. Banni Grassland	1. Uttarakhand
B. Bughal Grassland	2. Jammu & Kashmir
C. Khajjiar	3. Gujarat
D. Pahalgam	4. Himachal Pradesh

Codes :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	3	2	4
(b)	3	1	4	2
(c)	3	1	2	4
(d)	4	2	1	3

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

The correct match is :

Grassland/Hill Station	Location/State
Banni Grassland	Gujarat
Bughal Grassland	Uttarakhand
Khajjiar	Himachal Pradesh
Pahalgam	Jammu & Kashmir (U.T.)

Miscellaneous

*In 1850, the experimental Electric Telegraph started for the first time in India between Calcutta (Kolkata) and Diamond Harbor. *In early 1881, the **Oriental Telephone Company Limited** of England opened a telephone exchange in Calcutta (Kolkata), Bombay (Mumbai), Madras (Chennai) and Ahmedabad.

*The Indian Postal Department started the Speed Post Service on 1 August 1986. This service provides time-bound and express delivery of letters and parcels between specified stations in India.

***Biogas** refers to a mixture of different gases produced by the breakdown of organic matter in the absence of oxygen. *Biogas can be produced from raw materials such as agricultural waste, manure, sewage, green waste etc. It provides both power and manure.

***Thumba** is a suburb of Thiruvananthapuram city, the capital of Kerala. Under the leadership of Dr. Vikram A Sarabhai, the Indian National Committee on Space Research (INCOSPAR) decided to establish the Thumba Equatorial Rocket Launch Station (TERLS) at Thumba in 1963. Thumba was a unique choice because of its proximity to the geomagnetic equator.

*The **Bhabha Atomic Research Center (BARC)** is located in Maharashtra. ***Pokhran** is situated in Jaisalmer (Rajasthan). The first underground nuclear test was held in Pokhran. ***The Himalayan Mountaineering Institute** is in Darjeeling (West Bengal). ***Jawaharlal Nehru Agricultural University** is in Jabalpur (M.P.).

*Sardar Vallabh Bhai Patel University of Agriculture and Technology is in Meerut (U.P.). ***Indira Gandhi Agricultural University** was established in Raipur district of Chhattisgarh.

*India's first nuclear reactor is '**Apsara**', which started its operation in August 1956 at the Bhabha Atomic Research Center (BARC) in Trombay, Mumbai.

***Moradabad** is famous worldwide for brass works and glassware. Moradabad is also known by the name of **Peetal Nagri**. ***Chanderi** is a town of historical importance in Ashoknagar district of Madhya Pradesh. Chanderi is famous for its hand-woven sarees. ***Banarasi silk sarees** are famous worldwide. These sarees are known for their gold and silver brocade or zari, fine silk and opulent embroidery. ***Kanjivaram silk sarees** are made in Kanchipuram Tamil Nadu, so Kanchipuram is also known as the '**Varanasi of the South**'.

***Cairn** (currently Capricorn Energy) is one of the world's leading oil and gas exploration and development companies. Cairn has its headquarters in Edinburgh (Scotland). The company is listed on the London Stock Exchange and is engaged in oil production in Rajasthan (India).

***Aishbagh Stadium** is located in Bhopal (M.P.). ***Green Park Cricket Stadium** is located in Kanpur (U.P.). ***Eden Gardens** (Cricket Stadium) is located in West Bengal.

1. Which one of the following can provide both power and manure?

- (a) Nuclear plants
- (b) Thermal plants
- (c) Biogas plants
- (d) Hydroelectric plants

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Biogas refers to a mixture of different gases produced by the breakdown of organic matter in the absence of oxygen. Biogas can be produced from raw materials such as agricultural waste, manure, sewage, green waste, etc. It provides both power and manure.

2. When was 'Speed Post Service' launched by the Indian Postal Department in competition to the 'Courier service'?

- (a) 1988
- (b) 1987

(c) 1989

(d) 1986

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

The Indian Postal Department started the Speed Post Service in August 1986. This service provides time-bound and express delivery of letters and parcels between specified stations in India. If the Speed Post is not delivered within the time then the postal department refunds postal charges to the customers.

3. Which one of the following statements is NOT correct?

- (a) India is the second largest producer of nitrogenous fertilizers in the world
- (b) India is the ninth largest steel producing country in the world
- (c) India is the second largest producer of silk in the world
- (d) India ranks third in the world in coal production

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (a)

India was the third largest producer of nitrogenous fertilizers and the ninth largest steel producing country in the world when this question was asked. According to the Indian Minerals Yearbook, 2022 India is the second largest producer of coal and lignite after China in 2021. India is presently the second largest producer of crude steel.

4. Which of the following countries is the third largest producer and consumer of fertilizer in the world?

- (a) U.S.A.
- (b) China
- (c) India
- (d) Germany

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Locusts enter India from –

- (a) Bangladesh
- (b) Nepal
- (c) Pakistan
- (d) Sri Lanka

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

Locusts enter India from Pakistan.

6. Which one is not correctly matched ?

- (a) Sriharikota – Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Thumba – Kerala

- (c) Bhabha Atomic Research Centre – Karnataka
(d) Pokhran – Rajasthan

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

The correct match is as follows –

Sriharikota	–	Andhra Pradesh
Thumba	–	Kerala
Bhabha Atomic Research Centre	–	Maharashtra
Pokhran	–	Rajasthan

7. In the vicinity of Mumbai, a number of specialized towns have been developed. Match the lists of specialization with towns and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists :

List- I

(Town)

A. Alibag

B. Balapur

C. Nhava Sheva

D. Ratnagiri

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	3	2	4
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	3	4	2	1
(d)	2	1	4	3

List- II

(Specialization)

1. Fishing Centre

2. Holiday resort

3. Petro-chemical complex

4. Port

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

The places given above are in Maharashtra and famous for –
Alibag – is famous for Holiday resort.
Balapur – Petro-Chemical complex
Nhava Sheva – Fully mechanized port.
Ratnagiri – Fishing Centre

8. At one of the places in India, if you stand on the seashore and watch the sea, you will find that the seawater recedes from the shoreline a few kilometers and comes back to the shore, twice a day, and you can actually walk on the sea floor when the water recedes.

This unique phenomenon is seen at

- (a) Bhavnagar (b) Bheemunipatnam
(c) Chandipur (d) Nagapattinam

I.A.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

The above-mentioned phenomenon is seen at the seashore of Chandipur in the state of Odisha. One can walk into the beach as the seawater recedes away from the shoreline during the ebb tide (the time period between the high tide and low tide).

9. Which one of the following is the most important reason for the establishment of the Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre at Thumba?

- (a) The sea is near to the place in the east, west and south direction
(b) It is a place near to city in India which is nearest to the geographic equator
(c) It is situated on the geomagnetic equator
(d) Outer space near Thumba exhibits queer atmospheric phenomena

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Thumba is a suburb of Thiruvananthapuram city, the capital of Kerala. Under the leadership of Dr. Vikram A Sarabhai, the Indian National Committee on Space Research (INCOSPAR) decided to establish the Thumba Equatorial Rocket Launch Station (TERLS) at Thumba in 1963. Thumba was a unique choice because of its proximity to the geomagnetic equator.

10. "The Himalayan Mountaineering Institute" is located at–

- (a) Uttarkashi
(b) Dehradun
(c) Darjeeling
(d) Shillong

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

The Himalayan Mountaineering Institute (HMI) is located at Darjeeling (West Bengal).

11. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru Krishi- Madhya Pradesh
Vishwavidyalaya
(b) Sardar Vallabhbhai - Uttar Pradesh
Patel University of
Agriculture and

Technology

(c) Indira Gandhi Krishi - Rajasthan

Vishwavidyalaya

(d) Acharya NG Ranga - Telangana

Agriculture University

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (*)

Indira Gandhi Agriculture University (IGAU) is an agriculture university located in Raipur, Chhattisgarh, not in Rajasthan. Acharya NG Ranga Agriculture University located in Andhra Pradesh, not in Telangana. Options (c) and (d) are both not correctly matched.

12. The headquarters of Cairn Energy is in :

- (a) Scotland (b) South Korea
(c) Brazil (d) USA

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

Cairn (currently Capricorn Energy) is one of the world's leading oil and gas exploration and development companies. CAIRN has its headquarters in Edinburgh (Scotland).

13. Match the following :

- A. Rameshwaram** 1. Uttar Pradesh
B. Dwarka 2. Tamil Nadu
C. Sarnath 3. Gujarat
D. Mahakal Temple 4. Madhya Pradesh

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 |
| (b) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) | 1 | 4 | 2 | 3 |
| (d) | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

Rameshwaram is situated in Tamil Nadu, Dwarka is situated in Gujarat; Sarnath is situated in the Varanasi district of Uttar Pradesh; Mahakal Temple is situated in the Ujjain district of Madhya Pradesh.

14. Match the following :

- A. Aish Bagh Stadium** 1. Mumbai
B. Brabourne Stadium 2. Bhopal
C. Green Park 3. Calcutta
D. Eden Gardens 4. Kanpur

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 4 | 2 | 1 | 3 |
| (b) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) | 1 | 4 | 2 | 3 |
| (d) | 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

The correct match is as follows –

- | | | |
|-------------------|---|---------|
| Aish Bagh Stadium | – | Bhopal |
| Brabourne Stadium | – | Mumbai |
| Green Park | – | Kanpur |
| Eden Gardens | – | Kolkata |

15. Match the following :

- A. Underground Railway** 1. Ratnagiri
B. Mangoes 2. Calcutta
C. Locks 3. Dehradun
D. Rice 4. Aligarh

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (b) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (c) | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (d) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

Kolkata Metro is the first underground metro railway in India. Ratnagiri is famous for mangoes, Aligarh is famous for locks and Dehradun is famous for rice.

16. Diamond Harbour and Salt Lake City are situated in :

- (a) California (b) Florida
(c) Hong Kong (d) Kolkata

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Diamond Harbour and Salt Lake city are situated in Kolkata (West Bengal).

17. Dindigul is the name of –

- (a) Bird Sanctuary in Kerala
(b) City in Tamil Nadu

- (c) Festival in Karnataka
- (d) A coastal city in Andhra Pradesh

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

Dindigul is a city (district) in Tamil Nadu. Haider Ali established a modern arsenal in Dindigul with the help of France.

18. What is the object of Green Highway Policy ?

- (a) Tree plantation
- (b) Poverty alleviation
- (c) To provide health facilities
- (d) To increase the enrollment of dropout students
- (e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

The Government launched its Green Highway (Plantation, Transplantation, Beautification and Maintenance) Policy 2015. Its aim is to help the environment, assist local communities and generate employment by planting trees along all the highways in the country.

19. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

Area	Important Resources
(a) Kolhan	- Mineral Resources
(b) Kutch	- Forest Resources
(c) Malabar Coast	- Water Resources
(d) Middle Ganga Plain	- Soil Resources

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Forest resources are not available in the Kutch region. This region has abundant water resources. All other options are correctly matched.

20. Which of the following is not used in connection with sarees?

- (a) Chanderi
- (b) Moradabadi
- (c) Banarasi
- (d) Kanjivaram

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Moradabad is famous worldwide for brassworks and glassware. Moradabad is also known by the name of Peetal Nagri. Thus Moradabad is not related to sarees. Chanderi is a town of historical importance in Ashoknagar district of Madhya Pradesh. Chanderi is famous for its hand-woven sarees. Banarasi silk sarees are famous worldwide. These sarees are known for their gold and silver brocade or zari, fine silk and opulent embroidery. The Kanjivaram silk sarees are made in Kanchipuram, Tamil Nadu, so Kanchipuram is also known as the Varanasi of the South.

21. Which one of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) Dr. Manmohan Singh – Economics
- (b) Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam – Aeronautics
- (c) Dr. D.S. Kothari – Physics
- (d) Dr. M.S. Swaminathan – Geology

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Dr. M.S. Swaminathan, known as the 'Father of the Green Revolution', is related to agriculture not geology, the other options are correctly matched.

22. Where is the area known as 'Jangal Mahal' situated?

- (a) West Bengal
- (b) Jharkhand
- (c) Assam
- (d) Bihar

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (a)

Jangal Mahal is situated in West Bengal. It was in the news due to Naxalite activities.

23. The first nuclear reactor of India is named –

- (a) Apsara
- (b) Kamini
- (c) Rohini
- (d) Urvashi

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (a)

India's first nuclear reactor is 'Apsara' which started its operation in August 1956 at Bhabha Atomic Research Center (BARC) Trombay, Mumbai.

24. Telephone in India was introduced in –

- (a) 1951
- (b) 1981

(c) 1851

(d) 1861

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (*)

In 1850, the experimental electric telegraph started for the first time in India between Calcutta (Kolkata) and Diamond Harbor. In early 1881, the Oriental Telephone Company Limited of England opened telephone exchanges at Calcutta (Kolkata), Bombay (Mumbai), Madras (Chennai) and Ahmedabad. On 28th January 1882, the first formal telephone service was established. So, none of the options seem to be correct.

25. Which one of the following is not correctly matched?

(Heat Source)

(States of India)

(a) Lasundra

- Rajasthan

(b) Avloli

- Maharashtra

(c) Manikaran

- Himachal Pradesh

(d) Sohna

- Haryana

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

Lasundra hot water spring is in Gujarat. All other options are matched.

26. Consider the following pairs :

Tradition

State

1. Chapchar Kut festival - Mizoram

2. Khongjom Parba ballad - Manipur

3. Thang-Ta dance - Sikkim

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only

(b) 1 and 2

(c) 3 only

(d) 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Among the popular festivals of Mizoram, Mim Kut, Pawl Kut and Chapchar Kut, the 'Chapchar Kut festival' is celebrated in the month of March. It is celebrated after 'Jhoom' i.e. cleaning the forest. Khongjom Parba ballad and Thang-Ta dance (martial art) are traditions of Manipur. Hence pairs 1 and 2 are correctly matched.

27. Consider the following pairs :

Craft

Heritage of

1. Puthukkuli shawls

—

Tamil Nadu

2. Sujni embroidery

—

Maharashtra

3. Uppada Jamdani saris

—

Karnataka

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only

(b) 1 and 2

(c) 3 only

(d) 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

Puthukkuli shawls are made by Todas of Nilgiri hills in Tamil Nadu, locally called Pugur meaning flower. Sujani is a form of embroidery originating from the Bhusura village of Bihar. Uppada Jamdani sari is a silk style woven in Uppada of East Godavari district in the Indian state of Andhra Pradesh.

28. Recently, there was a growing awareness in our country about the importance of Himalayan nettle (*Girardinia diversifolia*) because it is found to be a sustainable source of-

(a) anti-malarial drug

(b) biodiesel

(c) pulp for paper industry

(d) textile fibre

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

Himalayan nettle (*Girardinia diversifolia*) is a plant found in the Himalayas and the Hindukush region, whose fiber is becoming increasingly popular for use in the textile industry. This plant is found in Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Jammu and Kashmir and several northeastern states of India, where efforts are being made by local weavers to increase its use in textile manufacturing.

29. The dust storms originating in Rajasthan in May and June months are caused due to

1. Origin of convectional currents at few places

2. Aravalli hills are parallel to southwestern winds

3. Origin of fast speedy easterly winds

Code :

(a) 1 and 3

(b) 1, 2 and 3

(c) 1 and 2

(d) Only 1

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

The origin of convective currents at some places is responsible for the dust storms that occur in the months of May and June in Rajasthan.